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Automated optimization of events by engagement and format

Abstract

Concepts and technologies disclosed herein are directed to automated optimization of events by engagement and format. According to one aspect disclosed herein, an event management system can create an event for a specified topic based upon input provided, at least in part, by an event creator. The input can identify initial event content, a plurality of event attendees, a location for the event, and an event presenter. The event management system can receive a selection of a desired audience for the event. The event management system can accept the initial event content to be presented during the event and can determine a time for the event. The event management system can perform engagement sampling during the event. The event management system can utilize the selection, the time, and the engagement sampling to optimize the event. The event management system can determine a follow-up action to be performed after the event.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

(1) Workplace and social event engagement needs are increasing for both digital and in-person participation. As a result, the need to measure and drive those engagements automatically is similarly growing. These needs are traditionally met by a pre-study of what the relevant topics to an audience may be, the most opportune time to hold the event, and the format of the event. These paradigms can be improved with automation.

(2) Often a formal system that measures workplace or social event engagement is not present during the event, or even afterwards. Additionally, systems that can dynamically modify content of an engagement, the presentation of that content, or the creation of the event for that engagement are not properly relegated to automated systems that can fully personalize the message for each participant.

(3) The disbursement of information and content from an engagement event is not properly monitored for breadth of distribution, nor is the impact and resonance of the event (e.g., as measured by additional engagement, performance improvement, and the like) attributed to modifications, distributions, or predicted engagements.

SUMMARY

(4) Concepts and technologies disclosed herein are directed to automated optimization of events by engagement and format. According to one aspect of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein, an event management system can create an event for a specified topic based upon input provided, at least in part, by an event creator. The input can identify initial event content, a plurality of event attendees, a location for the event, and an event presenter. The event management system can receive a selection of a desired audience for the event. In some embodiments, the selection is inferred by the event management system. In other embodiments, the selection is made manually by the event creator.

(5) The event management system can accept the initial event content to be presented during the event and can determine a time for the event. The event management system can perform engagement sampling during the event. The event management system can obtain feedback during the event and after the event. The event management system can determine a follow-up action to be performed after the event.

(6) In some embodiments, the event management system can determine a modification to the initial event content. The event management system can analyze the modification to determine whether to apply the modification to the initial event content. The event management system can apply the modification to the initial event content.

(7) In some embodiments, the event management system can perform the engagement sampling to monitor a traditional activation of at least a portion of the plurality of event attendees. In some embodiments, the event management system can perform the engagement sampling to monitor a question and answer session in which at least a portion of the plurality of event attendees participate. In some embodiments, the event management system can perform the engagement sampling to monitor an event acceptance rate. In some embodiments, the event management system can perform the engagement sampling to mine a specific event topic for relevance. In some embodiments, the event management system can monitor a social interaction among at least a portion of the plurality of event attendees. In some embodiments, the event management system can monitor a biometric of at least a portion of the plurality of event attendees. In some embodiments, the event management system can monitor a multi-tasking interaction of at least a portion of the plurality of event attendees.

(8) In some embodiments, the event management system can obtain the feedback from one or more

of the plurality of event attendees. In some embodiments, the event management system can obtain the feedback from the event creator. In some embodiments, the event management system can obtain the feedback from the event presenter.

(9) It should be appreciated that the above-described subject matter may be implemented as a computer-controlled apparatus, a computer process, a computing system, or as an article of manufacture such as a computer-readable storage medium. These and various other features will be apparent from a reading of the following Detailed Description and a review of the associated drawings.

(10) Other systems, methods, and/or computer program products according to embodiments will be or become apparent to one with skill in the art upon review of the following drawings and detailed description. It is intended that all such additional systems, methods, and/or computer program products be included within this description and be within the scope of this disclosure.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a block diagram illustrating aspects of an illustrative operating environment for various concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

(2) FIG. 2 is a flow diagram illustrating aspects of a method for automatically optimizing events by engagement and format, according to an illustrative embodiment of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

(3) FIG. 3 is a block diagram illustrating an example computer system capable of implementing aspects of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

(4) FIG. 4 is a block diagram illustrating an example mobile device capable of implementing aspects of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

(5) FIG. 5 is a block diagram illustrating an example network capable of implementing aspects of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

(6) FIG. 6 is a block diagram illustrating an example machine learning system capable of implementing aspects of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

(7) FIG. 7 is a block diagram illustrating a virtualized cloud architecture capable of implementing aspects of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(8) The concepts and technologies disclosed herein are directed to automated optimization of events by engagement and format. According to one aspect disclosed herein, a system can analyze event audiences, event content, engagement, and distribution, and can offer modifications to any or all components to increase retention. The system can provide encoding of all event input from initial planning, including the intended audience(s) and the content specifications (e.g., how the content is delivered and formatted, what the key message is, the ideal outcome, and the like). The system can learn from input and real-time metrics to predict outcomes and dynamically adjust content format and delivery as needed. The format and delivery can vary from one audience member to another based upon their characteristics. The system can analyze the flow of information post-event from person to person. For example, the system can determine whether information on certain topics shared should be siloed or disseminated throughout an organization. The system can use input, real-time metrics and post-mortem metrics to guide future event decisions. For example, the system can use the learned information from a study of topic distribution breadth to adjust content to focus in on key topics in the future.

(9) While the subject matter described herein is presented in the general context of program modules that execute in conjunction with the execution of an operating system and application programs on a computer system, those skilled in the art will recognize that other implementations

may be performed in combination with other types of program modules. Generally, program modules include routines, programs, components, data structures, and other types of structures that perform particular tasks or implement particular abstract data types. Moreover, those skilled in the art will appreciate that the subject matter described herein may be practiced with other computer system configurations, including hand-held devices, multiprocessor systems, microprocessor-based or programmable consumer electronics, minicomputers, mainframe computers, and the like.

(10) Turning now to FIG. 1, an operating environment **100** in which aspects of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein can be implemented will be described. The operating environment **100** includes an event creator **102** that can create an event **104** via an event management system **106**. In the illustrated example, the event creator **102** can provide input directly to the event management system **106**. Alternatively, the event creator **102** can provide input to another system such as a computer, smartphone, tablet, or other system/device that, in turn, provides the input to the event management system **106** as part of an event creation process. Moreover, the event creator **102** is described as a human but alternatively may be an artificial intelligence (“AI”). The event creator **102** may be a single entity or multiple entities that each contribute, in part, to the creation of the event **104**.

(11) The event management system **106** enables the event creator **102** to provide all event input for initial planning (shown as “initial event creation **110**”). The initial event creation **110** can identify event content **112**. It should be understood that the event content **112** may be modified during the event **104** as will be described in greater detail herein. As such, the event content **112** identified in the initial event creation **110** may be referred to herein as initial event content **112**, and the event content **112** that has been modified may be referred to herein as modified event content **112**. The term “event content **112**” therefore is intended to encompass the event content **112** as dynamic event content that may change over time. By way of example, and not limitation, the event content **112** can be or can include audio (e.g., live and/or recorded), video (e.g., live and/or recorded), still image(s), music, other digital media, digital or physical slide presentations, other physical media, combinations thereof, and/or the like. The event content **112** can be expressed as a specific topic or group of topics to be presented. The event content **112** can express what is the key message of the event **104**, what is the ideal outcome of the event **104**, and/or other aspects of the event **104**. The event content **112** can be stored locally on the event management system **106** and/or remotely on another system (not shown). The event content **112** can be distributed, as needed, to other system(s) and/or device(s) described herein.

(12) The initial event creation **110** can identify an intended audience such as one or more event attendees **114**, who may be in-person attendees, remote attendees, or a combination of in-person and remote attendees. The event attendee(s) **114** may be identified by name, a user name, an email address, a unique identifier (e.g., a combination of letters, numbers, and/or other characters), or the like. The initial event creation **110** also can identify attendee device(s) **116** associated with the event attendee(s) **114**. The attendee device(s) **116** may be a personal computer, a smartphone, a tablet, augmented reality device, virtual reality device, a combination thereof, and/or the like. In some implementations, only specific attendee devices **116** are allowed to be used during the event **104**. The initial event creation **110** also can identify one or more event location(s) **118** in which the event **104** is to be held. The event location(s) **118** can be or can include one or more physical locations (e.g., a conference center) and/or one or more virtual locations (e.g., a specific uniform resource locator specific to the event **104**).

(13) The initial event creation **110** can identify how the event content **112** is to be delivered to the event attendee(s) **114** during the event **104**. For example, the event content **112** may be delivered by one or more event presenters **120** with or without the aid of one or more presentation devices **122** (e.g., microphones, speakers, displays, and/or other presentation devices). The event presenter(s) **120** may be in-person and/or remote.

(14) The event management system **106**, the presentation device(s) **122**, and the event attendee

device(s) **116** can communicate via one or more networks **124**. The network(s) **124** can be or can include one or more local area networks (“LANs”). The network(s) **124** can be or can include one or more wide area network (“WANs”). The network(s) **124** can include wired networks, wireless networks, or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, the network(s) **124** can be configured similar to or the same as an example network **500** illustrated and described herein with reference to FIG. 5.

(15) The event management system **106** can learn from additional input and/or real-time metrics from the event creator **102**, the event attendee(s) **114**, the event presenter(s) **120**, or some combination thereof. This input and real-time metrics are illustrated collectively as feedback, and more particularly, as attendee feedback **126** from the event attendee(s) **114**, as presenter feedback **128** from the event presenter(s) **120**, and as event creator feedback **130** from the event creator **102**. The event management system **106** can utilize the attendee feedback **126**, the presenter feedback **128**, the event creator feedback **130**, or some combination thereof to predict one or more outcomes of the event **104** and can dynamically adjust the format and/or delivery of the event content **112** as needed. For example, the format and delivery of the event content **112** can vary from one event attendee **114** to another.

(16) The event management system **106** can analyze the flow of information after the event **104**. As such, the attendee feedback **126**, the presenter feedback **128**, and the event creator feedback **130** can include additional input provided after the event **104** by the event attendee(s) **114**, the event presenter(s) **120**, and/or the event creator **102**, respectively. In this manner, the event management system **106** can determine if information on certain topics shared during the event **104** should stay siloed within a group of the event attendees **114** or disseminated elsewhere, such as throughout an organization.

(17) The event management system **106** can utilize the attendee feedback **126**, the presenter feedback **128**, and the event creator feedback **130** to guide future event decisions. For example, the event management system **106** can use learnings from the study of topic distribution breadth to adjust the event content **112** to focus in on key topics in the future.

(18) The event management system **106** can utilize an architecture the same as or similar to a computer system **300** that is illustrated and described with reference to FIG. 3. Alternatively, the event management system **106** can utilize an architecture the same as or similar to a mobile device **400** that is illustrated and described with reference to FIG. 4. The event management system **106** can be implemented on a virtualized cloud architecture **700** that is illustrated and described with reference to FIG. 7. The event management system **106** can be, can include, or can otherwise utilize a machine learning system **600** that is illustrated and described with reference to FIG. 6.

(19) Turning now to FIG. 2, a flow diagram illustrating aspects of a method **200** for automatically optimizing events by engagement and format will be described, according to an illustrative embodiment. Although the method **200** will be described in context of a single event **104**, the method **200** can be used for multiple events **104** and processed sequentially or simultaneously. It should be understood that the operations of the method disclosed herein is not necessarily presented in any particular order and that performance of some or all of the operations in an alternative order(s) is possible and is contemplated. The operations have been presented in the demonstrated order for ease of description and illustration. Operations may be added, omitted, and/or performed simultaneously, without departing from the scope of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

(20) It also should be understood that the method disclosed herein can be ended at any time and need not be performed in its entirety. Some or all operations of the method, and/or substantially equivalent operations, can be performed by execution of computer-readable instructions included on a computer storage media, as defined herein. The term “computer-readable instructions,” and variants thereof, as used herein, is used expansively to include routines, applications, application modules, program modules, programs, components, data structures, algorithms, and the like.

Computer-readable instructions can be implemented on various system configurations including single-processor or multiprocessor systems, minicomputers, mainframe computers, personal computers, hand-held computing devices, microprocessor-based, programmable consumer electronics, combinations thereof, and the like.

(21) Thus, it should be appreciated that the logical operations described herein are implemented (1) as a sequence of computer implemented acts or program modules running on a computing system and/or (2) as interconnected machine logic circuits or circuit modules within the computing system. The implementation is a matter of choice dependent on the performance and other requirements of the computing system. Accordingly, the logical operations described herein are referred to variously as states, operations, structural devices, acts, or modules. These states, operations, structural devices, acts, and modules may be implemented in software, in firmware, in special purpose digital logic, and any combination thereof. As used herein, the phrase “cause a processor to perform operations” and variants thereof is used to refer to causing a processor of a computing system or device, or a portion thereof, to perform one or more operations, and/or causing the processor to direct other components of the computing system or device to perform one or more of the operations.

(22) For purposes of illustrating and describing the concepts of the present disclosure, operations of the methods disclosed herein are described as being performed alone or in combination via execution of one or more software modules, and/or other software/firmware components described herein. It should be understood that additional and/or alternative devices and/or network nodes can provide the functionality described herein via execution of one or more modules, applications, and/or other software. Thus, the illustrated embodiments are illustrative, and should not be viewed as being limiting in any way.

(23) The method **200** will be described from the perspective of the event management system **106** interacting with the event creator **102**, the event attendee(s) **114**, the event presenter(s) **120**, and their associated devices. In some embodiments, the event management system **106** is located on-site at the event location **118** and can communicate with the event attendee device(s) **116** and the presentation device(s) **122** over the network **124** embodied, for example, as a WLAN.

Alternatively, in other embodiments, the event management system **106** is located off-site from the event location **118** and can communicate with the event attendee device(s) **116** and the presentation device(s) **122** over the network **124** embodied, for example, as a WWAN. The event management system **106** can communicate with the event attendee device(s) **116** and the presentation device(s) **122** via multiple networks **124** such as a WWAN and a WLAN.

(24) The method **200** begins and proceeds to operation **202**. At operation **202**, the event management system **106** creates the event **104** for a specified topic based upon input provided by the event creator **102** as part of the initial event creation **110** for initial planning. In particular, the initial event creation **110** can identify the event content **112**, the event attendee(s) **114**, the attendee device(s) **116**, the event location(s) **118**, the event presenter(s) **120**, the presentation device(s) **122**, how the event content **112** is to be delivered to the event attendee(s) **114** during the event **104**, a combination thereof, and/or other aspects of the event **104**.

(25) From operation **202**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **204**. At operation **204**, the event management system **106** receives a selection of a desired audience, including one or more of the event attendees **114**. In some embodiments, the selection of the desired audience is a manual selection made, for example, by the event creator **102** (e.g., as identified as part of the initial event creation **110** or a separate selection made after the initial event creation **110**). In some other embodiments, the selection of the desired audience is inferred by the event management system **106** based, for example, upon the topic of the event **104**. In one embodiment, the audience selection process also conveys metadata about each audience member's preferences or profile. For example, the preference of one member to always receive event notifications via text message or only to show events during the final hours of a job assignment (e.g., the afternoon) may be known. In

another example, the rank or role significance of an audience member may be included in the metadata such that each audience member is designated with tenure (e.g., how long they have been a part of the organization) or management level (e.g., entry level, manager, vice president, etc.) or responsibility for a particular function within an organization (e.g., customer interacting, financial, human resources, knowledge worker, etc.). While these examples of metadata are explicitly provided, other profile and/or metadata pieces also may be included and utilized in the subsequent decision-making operations of the event management system **106**. Additionally, some metadata values may be directly computed by the event management system **106** from available data like the utilization number of peers that interact with a specific audience member to determine connectivity or reporting structures. In another embodiment, the metadata included with the audience may be aggregated in a way to compute consolidated preference scores, like a “VIP score,” which may determine both preferences and topics of interest for a specific audience member.

(26) From operation **204**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **206**. At operation **206**, the event management system **106** accepts the initial event content **112**. From operations **206**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **208**. At operation **208**, the event management system **106** determines, analyzes, and applies any content modifications to the initial event content **112**. In particular, the event management system **106** can modify the event content **112** for different audiences, for a different format delivery, and/or based upon expected knowledge and/or a prior understanding of the intended audience. For example, the event management system **106** can modify the delivery type, the delivery content, and the time and place of delivery. In one embodiment the event content **112** is modified to utilize only certain modalities, like audio channels, video or image channels, textual messages, or immersive (3D) content alone that corresponds to a specific attendee device **116**. In another embodiment, the modifications may alter the event content **112** to sub-select different portions of content (e.g., speeches, close-up of a product or demonstration, etc.) to include as the primary content (e.g., a still image), but have secondary content (e.g., spoken description) be overlayed. In yet another embodiment, time-based regions of content **112** may be selected by the specific attendee **114** profile or prior description. In another embodiment, portions of the event content **112** may also be delivered based on the event location **118** of either of (or both of) the presenter **120** and the attendee **114**.

(27) From operation **208**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **210**. At operation **210**, the event management system **106** determines a best time, duration, and/or interval for the event **104**. The event management system **106** can rank the audience by a score to bias the aggregate message, planning, and/or time planned. The event management system **106** can measure an active workload, frustration level, and/or other sentiments of the event attendee(s) **114**. In some embodiments, these metrics can be compared to historical values. Also at operation **210**, the event management system **106** can send an event notification (not shown) of the event **104** to each of the event attendees **114**. The event notification can be a digital notification such as an email, application message, or text message sent to the event attendee device(s) **116**. The event notification can be a physical notification such as a physical invitation letter mailed to a physical address associated with the event attendee **114**. In one embodiment, these notification types and preferences for receipt may be derived from profile information that was conveyed as metadata in operation **204**. In another embodiment, the type of notification may be derived from the type of formatting and modifications that occurred at operation **206**, where certain formats will receive more native notifications (e.g., text formatting receives text messages). In yet another embodiment, notifications may be sent by the event management system **106** during the event **104** to announce specific topics of the event content **112** (e.g., “special announcement for product Y in ten minutes”) or specific audiences (e.g., “for users with children under years of age”), or specific functions (e.g., “all interns observing their first quadruple bypass”) utilizing audience and metadata from operation **204**.

(28) From operation **210**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **212**. At operation **212**, the event management system **106** performs engagement sampling during the event **104**. For example, the

event management system **106** can monitor traditional activations such as clickthrough, measure behavioral differences (e.g., delta from known linger, reaction time); the event management system **106** can monitor question and answer sessions; the event management system **106** can monitor event acceptance rate; the event management system **106** can mine specific event topics for relevance; the event management system **106** can monitor forwarding/social sharing (e.g., retweet, content sharing, and/or other social interaction) within a connected social network and/or across organizational and/or geographical boundaries; the event management system **106** can monitor biometrics of the event attendee(s) **114** (e.g., via one or more biometric sensors at the event location(s) **118** and/or as part of the event attendee device(s) **116**) to understand attendee sentiment upon receipt of an event invitation, as well as interaction during the event **104**; the event management system **106** can monitor multi-tasking and/or ancillary interactions (e.g., application connections, interactions, and network connectivity); and the event management system **106** can join engagement sampling data with historical engagement sampling data to determine live, pre-recorded, and skipped portions of similar events **104**.

(29) From operation **212**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **214**. At operation **214**, the event management system **106** utilizes the outputs of audience determination (operation **204**), possible modifications (operation **206**), timing and notification (operation **210**), and engagement sampling (operation **212**) to optimize the event **104** and/or future iterations of the event **104**. In this manner, the event management system **106** can monitor engagement changes during the event **104**. The event management system **106** also can consider departures and/or interruptions by the event attendee(s) **114** to understand intentionality (e.g., due to a poor quality stream or an interrupter). Also at operation **214**, the event management system **106** can optimize timing and format of the event content **112** (e.g., for different roles such as the event attendee(s) **114** and/or the event presenter(s) **120**) through available modifications proposed in operation **206**. The event management system **106** also can optimize scheduling for future follow-up and/or repeat events **104**. In one embodiment, the follow-up and repeat events may be utilized to derive additional metadata for each audience member that describes durations of engagement and expected understanding rate for the event content **112**. In one example, if the event **104** was a training session, a percentage of training received and the specific topics may be recorded in the audience member's profile metadata and used in subsequent event planning. In another example, as a means of legal or obligator notification of customers or members of a more coherent audience, the event management system **106** may ascribe completion rates, notification acceptance, and acceptance of updates for certain topics into secondary auditing or event participation systems. In another example, the failed or partial receipt of event content **112** from the event **104** may be logged and later aggregated for a concise summarization of content (and accompanying notification) in a different format that is utilized for a subsequent event **104**.

(30) From operation **214**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **216**. At operation **216**, the event management system **106** obtains feedback, such as the attendee feedback **126**, the presenter feedback **128**, and/or the event creator feedback **130**, after the event **104**. Also at operation **216**, the event management system **106** applies the feedback to the event content **112** for future iterations. In one embodiment, future iterations of the event or events of this type may include methods to modify the types of content for certain audience members, the amount of advanced notification for certain events, and the relevant modifications utilized within processing of the event **104** for the corresponding audience members. In another embodiment, if future events are known by the event management system **106** and are centered around nearly identical content (e.g., broadcasts of the event **104** across different time zones or regions throughout the world), the event management system **106** may apply dramatic content modifications to test the efficacy of each of those modifications (on both content format and notification type). In yet another embodiment, the format of the event content **112** may be modified for different audience sets while retaining certain portions of the event content **112**. For example, certain audience members in a virtual space (e.g.,

an extended reality immersive experience) may appreciate the demonstration or specific product interactions within the event content **112** more than the introductory dialog, but the event creator **102** may have designated that introductory dialog as essential to any forms of the event **104**. In another embodiment, external metrics not related to the event management system **106**, such as employee or customer retention, may be introduced to the event management system **106** that, in turn, can further optimize the event **104** or its notifications as described above.

(31) From operation **216**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **218**. At operation **218**, the event management system **106** determines and performs follow-up actions after the event **104**. In one embodiment, follow-up actions are determined by the rate of dissemination, consumption, or actions taken based on the event content **112**. For example, the event management system **106** may monitor the rate of consumption (e.g., web- or video-based requests, clicks, opening of email, forwarding of event content **112**, and/or the like) of both attendees within the event **104** and the peers of the attendees not in the event **104**. In another example, data from topical sharing and search and asynchronous consumption of the event content **112** (e.g., excerpts, notifications, summarizations, and/or the like) may be monitored to understand the hierarchical or social distribution patterns of the content data throughout a larger audience set (e.g., the employees within an enterprise, the students of a class or university, or the customers within a product or market segment). As at operation **214**, these observations may be utilized to modify future events, future event content, and/or the notifications around those events. In some embodiments, a follow-up action can result in one or more of the event attendees **114** being targeted with invites to similar future events based upon their consumption patterns and predicted relevance.

(32) From operation **218**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **220**. The method **200** can end at operation **220**.

(33) Turning now to FIG. 3, a block diagram illustrating a computer system **300** configured to provide the functionality described herein in accordance with various embodiments. In some embodiments, the event management system **106** can be configured the same as or similar to the computer system **300**. In some embodiments, the event attendee device(s) **116** can be configured the same as or similar to the computer system **300**. In some embodiments, the presentation device(s) **122** can be configured the same as or similar to the computer system **300**.

(34) The computer system **300** includes a processing unit **302**, a memory **304**, one or more user interface devices **306**, one or more input/output (“I/O”) devices **308**, and one or more network devices **310**, each of which is operatively connected to a system bus **312**. The bus **312** enables bi-directional communication between the processing unit **302**, the memory **304**, the user interface devices **306**, the I/O devices **308**, and the network devices **310**.

(35) The processing unit **302** may be a standard central processor that performs arithmetic and logical operations, a more specific purpose programmable logic controller (“PLC”), a programmable gate array, or other type of processor known to those skilled in the art and suitable for controlling the operation of the server computer. The processing unit **302** can be a single processing unit or a multiple processing unit that includes more than one processing component. Processing units are generally known, and therefore are not described in further detail herein.

(36) The memory **304** communicates with the processing unit **302** via the system bus **312**. The memory **304** can include a single memory component or multiple memory components. In some embodiments, the memory **304** is operatively connected to a memory controller (not shown) that enables communication with the processing unit **302** via the system bus **312**. The memory **304** includes an operating system **314** and one or more program modules **316**. The operating system **314** can include, but is not limited to, members of the WINDOWS, WINDOWS CE, and/or WINDOWS MOBILE families of operating systems from MICROSOFT CORPORATION, the LINUX family of operating systems, the SYMBIAN family of operating systems from SYMBIAN LIMITED, the BREW family of operating systems from QUALCOMM CORPORATION, the MAC OSX, iOS, and/or families of operating systems from APPLE CORPORATION, the FREEB

SD family of operating systems, the SOLARIS family of operating systems from ORACLE CORPORATION, other operating systems, and the like.

(37) The program modules **316** may include various software and/or program modules described herein. The program modules **316** and/or other programs can be embodied in computer-readable media containing instructions that, when executed by the processing unit **302**, perform the method **200** described herein. According to embodiments, the program modules **316** may be embodied in hardware, software, firmware, or any combination thereof. The memory **304** also can be configured to store the initial event creation **110**, the event content **112**, the attendee feedback **126**, the presenter feedback **128**, the event creator feedback **130**, other data disclosed herein, or a combination thereof

(38) By way of example, and not limitation, computer-readable media may include any available computer storage media or communication media that can be accessed by the computer system **300**. Communication media includes computer-readable instructions, data structures, program modules, or other data in a modulated data signal such as a carrier wave or other transport mechanism and includes any delivery media. The term “modulated data signal” means a signal that has one or more of its characteristics changed or set in a manner as to encode information in the signal. By way of example, and not limitation, communication media includes wired media such as a wired network or direct-wired connection, and wireless media such as acoustic, RF, infrared and other wireless media. Combinations of any of the above should also be included within the scope of computer-readable media.

(39) Computer storage media includes volatile and non-volatile, removable and non-removable media implemented in any method or technology for storage of information such as computer-readable instructions, data structures, program modules, or other data. Computer storage media includes, but is not limited to, random access memory (“RAM”), read-only memory (“ROM”), Erasable Programmable ROM (“EPROM”), Electrically Erasable Programmable ROM (“EEPROM”), flash memory or other solid state memory technology, CD-ROM, digital versatile disks (“DVD”), or other optical storage, magnetic cassettes, magnetic tape, magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, or any other medium which can be used to store the desired information and which can be accessed by the computer system **300**. In the claims, the phrase “computer storage medium,” “computer-readable storage medium,” and variations thereof does not include waves or signals per se and/or communication media, and therefore should be construed as being directed to “non-transitory” media only.

(40) The user interface devices **306** may include one or more devices with which a user accesses the computer system **300**. The user interface devices **306** may include, but are not limited to, computers, servers, personal digital assistants, cellular phones, or any suitable computing devices. The I/O devices **308** enable a user to interface with the program modules **316**. In one embodiment, the I/O devices **308** are operatively connected to an I/O controller (not shown) that enables communication with the processing unit **302** via the system bus **312**. The I/O devices **308** may include one or more input devices, such as, but not limited to, a keyboard, a mouse, or an electronic stylus. Further, the I/O devices **308** may include one or more output devices, such as, but not limited to, a display or printer.

(41) The network devices **310** enable the computer system **300** to communicate with other networks or remote systems via one or more network(s) **318**, such as the network(s) **124** introduced above in FIG. **1**. Examples of the network devices **310** include, but are not limited to, a modem, a radio frequency (“RF”) or infrared (“IR”) transceiver, a telephonic interface, a bridge, a router, or a network card. The network **318** may include a wireless network such as, but not limited to, a Wireless Local Area Network (“WLAN”) such as a WI-FI network, a Wireless Wide Area Network (“WWAN”), a Wireless Personal Area Network (“WPAN”) such as BLUETOOTH, a Wireless Metropolitan Area Network (“WMAN”) such as a WiMAX network, or a cellular network. Alternatively, the network **318** may be a wired network such as, but not limited to, a Wide Area

Network (“WAN”) such as the Internet, a Local Area Network (“LAN”) such as the Ethernet, a wired Personal Area Network (“PAN”), or a wired Metropolitan Area Network (“MAN”).

(42) Turning now to FIG. 4, an illustrative mobile device **400** and components thereof will be described. In some embodiments, the event management system **106** can be configured the same as or similar to the mobile device **400**. In some embodiments, the event attendee device(s) **116** can be configured the same as or similar to the mobile device **400**. In some embodiments, the presentation device(s) **122** can be configured the same as or similar to the mobile device **400**. While connections are not shown between the various components illustrated in FIG. 4, it should be understood that some, none, or all of the components illustrated in FIG. 4 can be configured to interact with one another to carry out various device functions. In some embodiments, the components are arranged so as to communicate via one or more busses (not shown). Thus, it should be understood that FIG. 4 and the following description are intended to provide a general understanding of a suitable environment in which various aspects of embodiments can be implemented, and should not be construed as being limiting in any way.

(43) As illustrated in FIG. 4, the mobile device **400** can include a display **402** for displaying data. According to various embodiments, the display **402** can be configured to display various GUI elements, text, images, video, virtual keypads and/or keyboards, messaging data, notification messages, metadata, Internet content, device status, time, date, calendar data, device preferences, map and location data, combinations thereof, and/or the like. The mobile device **400** can also include a processor **404** and a memory or other data storage device (“memory”) **406**. The processor **404** can be configured to process data and/or can execute computer-executable instructions stored in the memory **406**. The computer-executable instructions executed by the processor **404** can include, for example, an operating system **408**, one or more applications **410**, other computer-executable instructions stored in the memory **406**, or the like. The memory **406** also can be configured to store the initial event creation **110**, the event content **112**, the attendee feedback **126**, the presenter feedback **128**, the event creator feedback **130**, other data disclosed herein, or a combination thereof.

(44) The UI application can interface with the operating system **408** to facilitate user interaction with functionality and/or data stored at the mobile device **400** and/or stored elsewhere. In some embodiments, the operating system **408** can include a member of the SYMBIAN OS family of operating systems from SYMBIAN LIMITED, a member of the WINDOWS MOBILE OS and/or WINDOWS PHONE OS families of operating systems from MICROSOFT CORPORATION, a member of the PALM WEBOS family of operating systems from HEWLETT PACKARD CORPORATION, a member of the BLACKBERRY OS family of operating systems from RESEARCH IN MOTION LIMITED, a member of the IOS family of operating systems from APPLE INC., a member of the ANDROID OS family of operating systems from GOOGLE LLC, and/or other operating systems. These operating systems are merely illustrative of some contemplated operating systems that may be used in accordance with various embodiments of the concepts and technologies described herein and therefore should not be construed as being limiting in any way.

(45) The UI application can be executed by the processor **404** to aid a user in entering/deleting data, entering and setting user IDs and passwords for device access, configuring settings, manipulating content and/or settings, multimode interaction, interacting with other applications **410**, and otherwise facilitating user interaction with the operating system **408**, the applications **410**, and/or other types or instances of data **412** that can be stored at the mobile device **400**.

(46) The applications **410**, the data **412**, and/or portions thereof can be stored in the memory **406** and/or in a firmware **414**, and can be executed by the processor **404**. The firmware **414** can also store code for execution during device power up and power down operations. It can be appreciated that the firmware **414** can be stored in a volatile or non-volatile data storage device including, but not limited to, the memory **406** and/or a portion thereof.

(47) The mobile device **400** can also include an input/output (“I/O”) interface **416**. The I/O interface **416** can be configured to support the input/output of data such as location information, presence status information, user IDs, passwords, and application initiation (start-up) requests. In some embodiments, the I/O interface **416** can include a hardwire connection such as a universal serial bus (“USB”) port, a mini-USB port, a micro-USB port, an audio jack, a PS2 port, an IEEE 1394 (“FIREWIRE”) port, a serial port, a parallel port, an Ethernet (RJ45) port, an RJ11 port, a proprietary port, combinations thereof, or the like. In some embodiments, the mobile device **400** can be configured to synchronize with another device to transfer content to and/or from the mobile device **400**. In some embodiments, the mobile device **400** can be configured to receive updates to one or more of the applications **410** via the I/O interface **416**, though this is not necessarily the case. In some embodiments, the I/O interface **416** accepts I/O devices such as keyboards, keypads, mice, interface tethers, printers, plotters, external storage, touch/multi-touch screens, touch pads, trackballs, joysticks, microphones, remote control devices, displays, projectors, medical equipment (e.g., stethoscopes, heart monitors, and other health metric monitors), modems, routers, external power sources, docking stations, combinations thereof, and the like. It should be appreciated that the I/O interface **416** may be used for communications between the mobile device **400** and a network device or local device.

(48) The mobile device **400** can also include a communications component **418**. The communications component **418** can be configured to interface with the processor **404** to facilitate wired and/or wireless communications with one or more networks, such as the network **318**, the Internet, or some combination thereof. In some embodiments, the communications component **418** includes a multimode communications subsystem for facilitating communications via the cellular network and one or more other networks.

(49) The communications component **418**, in some embodiments, includes one or more transceivers. The one or more transceivers, if included, can be configured to communicate over the same and/or different wireless technology standards with respect to one another. For example, in some embodiments, one or more of the transceivers of the communications component **418** may be configured to communicate using Global System for Mobile communications (“GSM”), Code-Division Multiple Access (“CDMA”) CDMAONE, CDMA2000, Long-Term Evolution (“LTE”) LTE, and various other 2G, 2.5G, 3G, 4G, 4.5G, 5G, and greater generation technology standards. Moreover, the communications component **418** may facilitate communications over various channel access methods (which may or may not be used by the aforementioned standards) including, but not limited to, Time-Division Multiple Access (“TDMA”), Frequency-Division Multiple Access (“FDMA”), Wideband CDMA (“W-CDMA”), Orthogonal Frequency-Division Multiple Access (“OFDMA”), Space-Division Multiple Access (“SDMA”), and the like.

(50) In addition, the communications component **418** may facilitate data communications using General Packet Radio Service (“GPRS”), Enhanced Data services for Global Evolution (“EDGE”), the High-Speed Packet Access (“HSPA”) protocol family including High-Speed Downlink Packet Access (“HSDPA”), Enhanced Uplink (“EUL”) (also referred to as High-Speed Uplink Packet Access (“HSUPA”), HSPA+, and various other current and future wireless data access standards. In the illustrated embodiment, the communications component **418** can include a first transceiver (“TxRx”) **420A** that can operate in a first communications mode (e.g., GSM). The communications component **418** can also include an N.sup.th transceiver (“TxRx”) **420N** that can operate in a second communications mode relative to the first transceiver **420A** (e.g., UMTS). While two transceivers **420A-420N** (hereinafter collectively and/or generically referred to as “transceivers **420**”) are shown in FIG. 4, it should be appreciated that less than two, two, and/or more than two transceivers **420** can be included in the communications component **418**.

(51) The communications component **418** can also include an alternative transceiver (“Alt TxRx”) **422** for supporting other types and/or standards of communications. According to various contemplated embodiments, the alternative transceiver **422** can communicate using various

communications technologies such as, for example, WI-FI, WIMAX, BLUETOOTH, infrared, infrared data association (“IRDA”), near field communications (“NFC”), other RF technologies, combinations thereof, and the like. In some embodiments, the communications component **418** can also facilitate reception from terrestrial radio networks, digital satellite radio networks, internet-based radio service networks, combinations thereof, and the like. The communications component **418** can process data from a network such as the Internet, an intranet, a broadband network, a WI-FI hotspot, an Internet service provider (“ISP”), a digital subscriber line (“DSL”) provider, a broadband provider, combinations thereof, or the like.

(52) The mobile device **400** can also include one or more sensors **424**. The sensors **424** can include temperature sensors, light sensors, air quality sensors, movement sensors, accelerometers, magnetometers, gyroscopes, infrared sensors, orientation sensors, noise sensors, microphones proximity sensors, combinations thereof, and/or the like. Additionally, audio capabilities for the mobile device **400** may be provided by an audio I/O component **426**. The audio I/O component **426** of the mobile device **400** can include one or more speakers for the output of audio signals, one or more microphones for the collection and/or input of audio signals, and/or other audio input and/or output devices.

(53) The illustrated mobile device **400** can also include a subscriber identity module (“SIM”) system **428**. The SIM system **428** can include a universal SIM (“USIM”), a universal integrated circuit card (“UICC”) and/or other identity devices. The SIM system **428** can include and/or can be connected to or inserted into an interface such as a slot interface **430**. In some embodiments, the slot interface **430** can be configured to accept insertion of other identity cards or modules for accessing various types of networks. Additionally, or alternatively, the slot interface **430** can be configured to accept multiple subscriber identity cards. Because other devices and/or modules for identifying users and/or the mobile device **400** are contemplated, it should be understood that these embodiments are illustrative, and should not be construed as being limiting in any way.

(54) The mobile device **400** can also include an image capture and processing system **432** (“image system”). The image system **432** can be configured to capture or otherwise obtain photos, videos, and/or other visual information. As such, the image system **432** can include cameras, lenses, charge-coupled devices (“CCDs”), combinations thereof, or the like. The mobile device **400** may also include a video system **434**. The video system **434** can be configured to capture, process, record, modify, and/or store video content. Photos and videos obtained using the image system **432** and the video system **434**, respectively, may be added as message content to an MMS message, email message, and sent to another device. The video and/or photo content can also be shared with other devices via various types of data transfers via wired and/or wireless communication devices as described herein.

(55) The mobile device **400** can also include one or more location components **436**. The location components **436** can be configured to send and/or receive signals to determine a geographic location of the mobile device **400**. According to various embodiments, the location components **436** can send and/or receive signals from global positioning system (“GPS”) devices, assisted-GPS (“A-GPS”) devices, WI-FI/WIMAX and/or cellular network triangulation data, combinations thereof, and the like. The location component **436** can also be configured to communicate with the communications component **418** to retrieve triangulation data for determining a location of the mobile device **400**. In some embodiments, the location component **436** can interface with cellular network nodes, telephone lines, satellites, location transmitters and/or beacons, wireless network transmitters and receivers, combinations thereof, and the like. In some embodiments, the location component **436** can include and/or can communicate with one or more of the sensors **424** such as a compass, an accelerometer, and/or a gyroscope to determine the orientation of the mobile device **400**. Using the location component **436**, the mobile device **400** can generate and/or receive data to identify its geographic location, or to transmit data used by other devices to determine the location of the mobile device **400**. The location component **436** may include multiple components for

identifying the location and/or orientation of the mobile device **400**.

(56) The illustrated mobile device **400** can also include a power source **438**. The power source **438** can include one or more batteries, power supplies, power cells, and/or other power subsystems including alternating current (“AC”) and/or direct current (“DC”) power devices. The power source **438** can also interface with an external power system or charging equipment via a power I/O component **440**. Because the mobile device **400** can include additional and/or alternative components, the above embodiment should be understood as being illustrative of one possible operating environment for various embodiments of the concepts and technologies described herein. The described embodiment of the mobile device **400** is illustrative, and should not be construed as being limiting in any way.

(57) As used herein, communication media includes computer-executable instructions, data structures, program modules, or other data in a modulated data signal such as a carrier wave or other transport mechanism and includes any delivery media. The term “modulated data signal” means a signal that has one or more of its characteristics changed or set in a manner as to encode information in the signal. By way of example, and not limitation, communication media includes wired media such as a wired network or direct-wired connection, and wireless media such as acoustic, RF, infrared, and other wireless media. Combinations of any of the above should also be included within the scope of computer-readable media.

(58) By way of example, and not limitation, computer storage media may include volatile and non-volatile, removable and non-removable media implemented in any method or technology for storage of information such as computer-executable instructions, data structures, program modules, or other data. For example, computer media includes, but is not limited to, RAM, ROM, EPROM, EEPROM, flash memory or other solid state memory technology, CD-ROM, digital versatile disks (“DVD”), HD-DVD, BLU-RAY, or other optical storage, magnetic cassettes, magnetic tape, magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, or any other medium which can be used to store the desired information and which can be accessed by the mobile device **400** or other devices or computers described herein, such as the computer system **300** described above with reference to FIG. 3. In the claims, the phrase “computer storage medium,” “computer-readable storage medium,” and variations thereof does not include waves or signals per se and/or communication media, and therefore should be construed as being directed to “non-transitory” media only.

(59) Encoding the software modules presented herein also may transform the physical structure of the computer-readable media presented herein. The specific transformation of physical structure may depend on various factors, in different implementations of this description. Examples of such factors may include, but are not limited to, the technology used to implement the computer-readable media, whether the computer-readable media is characterized as primary or secondary storage, and the like. For example, if the computer-readable media is implemented as semiconductor-based memory, the software disclosed herein may be encoded on the computer-readable media by transforming the physical state of the semiconductor memory. For example, the software may transform the state of transistors, capacitors, or other discrete circuit elements constituting the semiconductor memory. The software also may transform the physical state of such components in order to store data thereupon.

(60) As another example, the computer-readable media disclosed herein may be implemented using magnetic or optical technology. In such implementations, the software presented herein may transform the physical state of magnetic or optical media, when the software is encoded therein. These transformations may include altering the magnetic characteristics of particular locations within given magnetic media. These transformations also may include altering the physical features or characteristics of particular locations within given optical media, to change the optical characteristics of those locations. Other transformations of physical media are possible without departing from the scope and spirit of the present description, with the foregoing examples provided only to facilitate this discussion.

(61) In light of the above, it should be appreciated that many types of physical transformations may take place in the mobile device **400** in order to store and execute the software components presented herein. It is also contemplated that the mobile device **400** may not include all of the components shown in FIG. **4**, may include other components that are not explicitly shown in FIG. **4**, or may utilize an architecture completely different than that shown in FIG. **4**.

(62) Turning now to FIG. **5**, details of a network **500** are illustrated, according to an illustrative embodiment. In some embodiments, the network(s) **124** shown in FIG. **1** and/or the network **318** shown in FIG. **3** can be configured the same as or similar to the network **500**. The network **500** includes a cellular network **502**, a packet data network **504**, and a circuit switched network **506** (e.g., a public switched telephone network). The cellular network **502** includes various components such as, but not limited to, base transceiver stations (“BTSS”), Node-Bs or e-Node-Bs, base station controllers (“BSCs”), radio network controllers (“RNCs”), mobile switching centers (“MSCs”), mobility management entities (“MMEs”), short message service centers (“SMSCs”), multimedia messaging service centers (“MMSCs”), home location registers (“HLRs”), home subscriber servers (“HSSs”), visitor location registers (“VLRs”), charging platforms, billing platforms, voicemail platforms, GPRS core network components, location service nodes, and the like. The cellular network **502** also includes radios and nodes for receiving and transmitting voice, data, and combinations thereof to and from radio transceivers, networks, the packet data network **504**, and the circuit switched network **506**.

(63) A mobile communications device **508**, such as, for example, the mobile device **400**, a cellular telephone, a user equipment, a mobile terminal, a PDA, a laptop computer, a handheld computer, and combinations thereof, can be operatively connected to the cellular network **502**. The mobile communications device **508** can be configured similar to or the same as the mobile device **400** described above with reference to FIG. **4**.

(64) The cellular network **502** can be configured as a GSM network and can provide data communications via GPRS and/or EDGE. Additionally, or alternatively, the cellular network **502** can be configured as a 3G Universal Mobile Telecommunications System (“UMTS”) network and can provide data communications via the HSPA protocol family, for example, HSDPA, EUL, and HSPA+. The cellular network **502** also is compatible with mobile communications standards such as LTE, or the like, as well as evolved and future mobile standards.

(65) The packet data network **504** includes various systems, devices, servers, computers, databases, and other devices in communication with one another, as is generally known. The event management system **106**, the event attendee device(s) **116**, the presentation device(s) **122**, or some combination thereof can communicate with each other via the packet data network **504**. In some embodiments, the packet data network **504** is or includes one or more WI-FI networks, each of which can include one or more WI-FI access points, routers, switches, and other WI-FI network components. The packet data network **504** devices are accessible via one or more network links. The servers often store various files that are provided to a requesting device such as, for example, a computer, a terminal, a smartphone, or the like. Typically, the requesting device includes software for executing a web page in a format readable by the browser or other software. Other files and/or data may be accessible via “links” in the retrieved files, as is generally known. In some embodiments, the packet data network **504** includes or is in communication with the Internet. The circuit switched network **506** includes various hardware and software for providing circuit switched communications. The circuit switched network **506** may include, or may be, what is often referred to as a plain old telephone system (“POTS”). The functionality of a circuit switched network **506** or other circuit-switched network are generally known and will not be described herein in detail.

(66) The illustrated cellular network **502** is shown in communication with the packet data network **504** and a circuit switched network **506**, though it should be appreciated that this is not necessarily the case. One or more Internet-capable systems/devices **510** such as the event management system **106**, the event attendee device(s) **116**, the presentation device(s) **122**, a laptop, a portable device, or

another suitable device, can communicate with one or more cellular networks **502**, and devices connected thereto, through the packet data network **504**. It also should be appreciated that the Internet-capable device **510** can communicate with the packet data network **504** through the circuit switched network **506**, the cellular network **502**, and/or via other networks (not illustrated). (67) As illustrated, a communications device **512**, for example, a telephone, facsimile machine, modem, computer, or the like, can be in communication with the circuit switched network **506**, and therethrough to the packet data network **504** and/or the cellular network **502**. It should be appreciated that the communications device **512** can be an Internet-capable device, and can be substantially similar to the Internet-capable device **510**.

(68) Turning now to FIG. **6**, a machine learning system **600** capable of implementing aspects of the embodiments disclosed herein will be described. In some embodiments, aspects of the event management system **106**, the event attendee device(s) **116**, the presentation device(s) **122**, or a combination thereof can be improved via machine learning. Accordingly, the event management system **106**, the event attendee device(s) **116**, the presentation device(s) **122**, or a combination thereof can include or can be in communication with a machine learning system **600** or multiple machine learning systems **600**.

(69) The illustrated machine learning system **600** includes one or more machine learning models **602**. The machine learning models **602** can include, unsupervised, supervised, and/or semi-supervised learning models. The machine learning model(s) **602** can be created by the machine learning system **600** based upon one or more machine learning algorithms **604**. The machine learning algorithm(s) **604** can be any existing, well-known algorithm, any proprietary algorithms, or any future machine learning algorithm. Some example machine learning algorithms **604** include, but are not limited to, neural networks, gradient descent, linear regression, logistic regression, linear discriminant analysis, classification tree, regression tree, Naive Bayes, K-nearest neighbor, learning vector quantization, support vector machines, any of the algorithms described herein, and the like. Classification and regression algorithms might find particular applicability to the concepts and technologies disclosed herein. Those skilled in the art will appreciate the applicability of various machine learning algorithms **604** based upon the problem(s) to be solved by machine learning via the machine learning system **600**.

(70) The machine learning system **600** can control the creation of the machine learning models **602** via one or more training parameters. In some embodiments, the training parameters are selected modelers at the direction of an enterprise, for example. Alternatively, in some embodiments, the training parameters are automatically selected based upon data provided in one or more training data sets **606**. The training parameters can include, for example, a learning rate, a model size, a number of training passes, data shuffling, regularization, and/or other training parameters known to those skilled in the art.

(71) The learning rate is a training parameter defined by a constant value. The learning rate affects the speed at which the machine learning algorithm **604** converges to the optimal weights. The machine learning algorithm **604** can update the weights for every data example included in the training data set **606**. The size of an update is controlled by the learning rate. A learning rate that is too high might prevent the machine learning algorithm **604** from converging to the optimal weights. A learning rate that is too low might result in the machine learning algorithm **604** requiring multiple training passes to converge to the optimal weights.

(72) The model size is regulated by the number of input features (“features”) **608** in the training data set **606**. A greater the number of features **608** yields a greater number of possible patterns that can be determined from the training data set **606**. The model size should be selected to balance the resources (e.g., compute, memory, storage, etc.) needed for training and the predictive power of the resultant machine learning model **602**.

(73) The number of training passes indicates the number of training passes that the machine learning algorithm **604** makes over the training data set **606** during the training process. The

number of training passes can be adjusted based, for example, on the size of the training data set **606**, with larger training data sets being exposed to fewer training passes in consideration of time and/or resource utilization. The effectiveness of the resultant machine learning model **602** can be increased by multiple training passes.

(74) Data shuffling is a training parameter designed to prevent the machine learning algorithm **604** from reaching false optimal weights due to the order in which data contained in the training data set **606** is processed. For example, data provided in rows and columns might be analyzed first row, second row, third row, etc., and thus an optimal weight might be obtained well before a full range of data has been considered. By data shuffling, the data contained in the training data set **606** can be analyzed more thoroughly and mitigate bias in the resultant machine learning model **602**.

(75) Regularization is a training parameter that helps to prevent the machine learning model **602** from memorizing training data from the training data set **606**. In other words, the machine learning model **602** fits the training data set **606**, but the predictive performance of the machine learning model **602** is not acceptable. Regularization helps the machine learning system **600** avoid this overfitting/memorization problem by adjusting extreme weight values of the features **608**. For example, a feature that has a small weight value relative to the weight values of the other features in the training data set **606** can be adjusted to zero.

(76) The machine learning system **600** can determine model accuracy after training by using one or more evaluation data sets **610** containing the same features **608'** as the features **608** in the training data set **606**. This also prevents the machine learning model **602** from simply memorizing the data contained in the training data set **606**. The number of evaluation passes made by the machine learning system **600** can be regulated by a target model accuracy that, when reached, ends the evaluation process and the machine learning model **602** is considered ready for deployment.

(77) After deployment, the machine learning model **602** can perform a prediction operation (“prediction”) **614** with an input data set **612** having the same features **608'** as the features **608** in the training data set **606** and the features **608'** of the evaluation data set **610**. The results of the prediction **614** are included in an output data set **616** consisting of predicted data. The machine learning model **602** can perform other operations, such as regression, classification, and others. As such, the example illustrated in FIG. 6 should not be construed as being limiting in any way.

(78) Turning now to FIG. 7, a block diagram illustrating an example virtualized cloud architecture **700** and components thereof will be described, according to an exemplary embodiment. In some embodiments, the virtualized cloud architecture **700** can be utilized to implement, at least in part, the event management system **106**, the event attendee device(s) **116**, the presentation device(s) **122**, the network(s) **124/318/500**, or some combination thereof. The virtualized cloud architecture **700** is a shared infrastructure that can support multiple services and network applications. The illustrated virtualized cloud architecture **700** includes a hardware resource layer **702**, a control layer **704**, a virtual resource layer **706**, and an application layer **708** that work together to perform operations as will be described in detail herein.

(79) The hardware resource layer **702** provides hardware resources, which, in the illustrated embodiment, include one or more compute resources **710**, one or more memory resources **712**, and one or more other resources **714**. The compute resource(s) **710** can include one or more hardware components that perform computations to process data, and/or to execute computer-executable instructions of one or more application programs, operating systems, and/or other software. The compute resources **710** can include one or more central processing units (“CPUs”) configured with one or more processing cores. The compute resources **710** can include one or more graphics processing unit (“GPU”) configured to accelerate operations performed by one or more CPUs, and/or to perform computations to process data, and/or to execute computer-executable instructions of one or more application programs, operating systems, and/or other software that may or may not include instructions particular to graphics computations. In some embodiments, the compute resources **710** can include one or more discrete GPUs. In some other embodiments, the compute

resources **710** can include CPU and GPU components that are configured in accordance with a co-processing CPU/GPU computing model, wherein the sequential part of an application executes on the CPU and the computationally-intensive part is accelerated by the GPU. The compute resources **710** can include one or more system-on-chip (“SoC”) components along with one or more other components, including, for example, one or more of the memory resources **712**, and/or one or more of the other resources **714**. In some embodiments, the compute resources **710** can be or can include one or more SNAPDRAGON SoCs, available from QUALCOMM; one or more TEGRA SoCs, available from NVIDIA; one or more HUMMINGBIRD SoCs, available from SAMSUNG; one or more Open Multimedia Application Platform (“OMAP”) SoCs, available from TEXAS INSTRUMENTS; one or more customized versions of any of the above SoCs; and/or one or more proprietary SoCs. The compute resources **710** can be or can include one or more hardware components architected in accordance with an advanced reduced instruction set computing (“RISC”) machine (“ARM”) architecture, available for license from ARM HOLDINGS. Alternatively, the compute resources **710** can be or can include one or more hardware components architected in accordance with an x86 architecture, such an architecture available from INTEL CORPORATION of Mountain View, California, and others. Those skilled in the art will appreciate the implementation of the compute resources **710** can utilize various computation architectures, and as such, the compute resources **710** should not be construed as being limited to any particular computation architecture or combination of computation architectures, including those explicitly disclosed herein.

(80) The memory resource(s) **712** can include one or more hardware components that perform storage operations, including temporary or permanent storage operations. In some embodiments, the memory resource(s) **712** include volatile and/or non-volatile memory implemented in any method or technology for storage of information such as computer-readable instructions, data structures, program modules, or other data disclosed herein. Computer storage media includes, but is not limited to, random access memory (“RAM”), read-only memory (“ROM”), Erasable Programmable ROM (“EPROM”), Electrically Erasable Programmable ROM (“EEPROM”), flash memory or other solid state memory technology, CD-ROM, digital versatile disks (“DVD”), or other optical storage, magnetic cassettes, magnetic tape, magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, or any other medium which can be used to store data and which can be accessed by the compute resources **710**.

(81) The other resource(s) **714** can include any other hardware resources that can be utilized by the compute resources(s) **710** and/or the memory resource(s) **712** to perform operations described herein. The other resource(s) **714** can include one or more input and/or output processors (e.g., network interface controller or wireless radio), one or more modems, one or more codec chipset, one or more pipeline processors, one or more fast Fourier transform (“FFT”) processors, one or more digital signal processors (“DSPs”), one or more speech synthesizers, and/or the like.

(82) The hardware resources operating within the hardware resource layer **702** can be virtualized by one or more virtual machine monitors (“VMMs”) **716A-716N** (also known as “hypervisors;” hereinafter “VMMs **716**”) operating within the control layer **704** to manage one or more virtual resources that reside in the virtual resource layer **706**. The VMMs **716** can be or can include software, firmware, and/or hardware that alone or in combination with other software, firmware, and/or hardware, manages one or more virtual resources operating within the virtual resource layer **706**.

(83) The virtual resources operating within the virtual resource layer **706** can include abstractions of at least a portion of the compute resources **710**, the memory resources **712**, the other resources **714**, or any combination thereof. These abstractions are referred to herein as virtual machines (“VMs”). In the illustrated embodiment, the virtual resource layer **706** includes VMs **718A-718N** (hereinafter “VMs **718**”). Each of the VMs **718** can execute one or more applications **720A-720N** in the application layer **708**.

(84) Based on the foregoing, it should be appreciated that aspects of automated optimization of events by engagement and format have been disclosed herein. Although the subject matter presented herein has been described in language specific to computer structural features, methodological and transformative acts, specific computing machinery, and computer-readable media, it is to be understood that the concepts and technologies disclosed herein are not necessarily limited to the specific features, acts, or media described herein. Rather, the specific features, acts and mediums are disclosed as example forms of implementing the concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

(85) The subject matter described above is provided by way of illustration only and should not be construed as limiting. Various modifications and changes may be made to the subject matter described herein without following the example embodiments and applications illustrated and described, and without departing from the true spirit and scope of the embodiments of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

Claims

1. A method comprising: creating, by an event management system comprising a processor, an event for a specified topic based upon input provided, at least in part, by an event creator, wherein the input identifies a plurality of event attendees; receiving, by the event management system, a selection of a desired audience for the event, wherein receiving the selection of the desired audience for the event comprises receiving, by the event management system, the selection of at least one of the plurality of event attendees as the desired audience, and wherein the selection comprises an inferred selection or a manual selection; determining, by the event management system, at least one device associated with at least a portion of the desired audience; accepting, by the event management system, an initial event content to be presented during the event; determining, by the event management system, a time for the event; performing, by the event management system, engagement sampling during the event, wherein performing the engagement sampling comprises monitoring, via at least one biometric sensor, biometrics of the at least one of the plurality of event attendees; utilizing, by the event management system, the selection of the desired audience, the at least one device associated with at least the portion of the desired audience, the time for the event, and the engagement sampling to optimize the event, wherein the event is optimized by modifying, by the event management system, at least a portion of the initial event content automatically during the event; and determining, by the event management system, a follow-up action to be performed after the event.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein the input further identifies the initial event content, a location for the event, and an event presenter.

3. The method of claim 1, wherein modifying at least a portion of the initial event content automatically during the event comprises: determining, by the event management system, a modification to the initial event content; analyzing, by the event management system, the modification to determine whether to apply the modification to the initial event content; and applying, by the event management system, the modification to the initial event content.

4. The method of claim 3, wherein performing, by the event management system, the engagement sampling comprises: monitoring, by the event management system, a traditional activation of at least a portion of the plurality of event attendees; monitoring, by the event management system, a question and answer session; monitoring, by the event management system, an event acceptance rate; mining, by the event management system, a specific event topic for relevance; monitoring, by the event management system, a social interaction among at least a portion of the plurality of event attendees; or monitoring, by the event management system, a multi-tasking interaction of at least a portion of the plurality of event attendees.

5. The method of claim 1, further comprising obtaining, by the event management system,

- feedback during the event and after the event, wherein obtaining the feedback comprises obtaining, by the event management system, attendee feedback during the event and after the event.
6. An event management system comprising: a processor; and a memory comprising instructions that, when executed by the processor, cause the processor to perform operations comprising creating an event for a specified topic based upon input provided, at least in part, by an event creator, wherein the input identifies a plurality of event attendees, receiving a selection of a desired audience for the event, wherein receiving the selection of the desired audience for the event comprises receiving, by the event management system, the selection of at least one of the plurality of event attendees as the desired audience, and wherein the selection comprises an inferred selection or a manual selection, determining at least one device associated with at least a portion of the desired audience, accepting an initial event content to be presented during the event, determining a time for the event, performing engagement sampling during the event, wherein performing the engagement sampling comprises monitoring, via at least one biometric sensor, biometrics of the at least one of the plurality of event attendees, utilizing the selection of the desired audience, the at least one device associated with at least the portion of the desired audience, the time for the event, and the engagement sampling to optimize the event, wherein the event is optimized by modifying at least a portion of the initial event content automatically during the event, and determining a follow-up action to be performed after the event.
7. The event management system of claim 6, wherein the input further identifies the initial event content, a location for the event, and an event presenter.
8. The event management system of claim 6, wherein modifying at least a portion of the initial event content automatically during the event comprises: determining a modification to the initial event content; analyzing the modification to determine whether to apply the modification to the initial event content; and applying the modification to the initial event content.
9. The event management system of claim 8, wherein performing the engagement sampling comprises: monitoring a traditional activation of at least a portion of the plurality of event attendees; monitoring a question and answer session; monitoring an event acceptance rate; mining a specific event topic for relevance; monitoring a social interaction among at least a portion of the plurality of event attendees; or monitoring a multi-tasking interaction of at least a portion of the plurality of event attendees.
10. The event management system of claim 6, wherein the operations further comprise obtaining feedback during the event and after the event, wherein obtaining the feedback comprises obtaining attendee feedback during the event and after the event.
11. A computer-readable storage medium comprising computer-executable instructions that, when executed by a processor of an event management system, cause the processor to perform operations comprising: creating an event for a specified topic based upon input provided, at least in part, by an event creator, wherein the input identifies a plurality of event attendees; receiving a selection of a desired audience for the event, wherein receiving the selection of the desired audience for the event comprises receiving, by the event management system, the selection of at least one of the plurality of event attendees as the desired audience, and wherein the selection comprises an inferred selection or a manual selection; determining at least one device associated with at least a portion of the desired audience; accepting an initial event content to be presented during the event; determining a time for the event; performing engagement sampling during the event, wherein performing the engagement sampling comprises monitoring, via at least one biometric sensor, biometrics of the at least one of the plurality of event attendees; utilizing the selection of the desired audience, the at least one device associated with at least the portion of the desired audience, the time for the event, and the engagement sampling to optimize the event, wherein the event is optimized by modifying at least a portion of the initial event content automatically during the event; and determining a follow-up action to be performed after the event.
12. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 11, wherein the input further identifies the

initial event content, a location for the event, and an event presenter.

13. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 11, wherein modifying at least a portion of the initial event content automatically during the event comprises: determining a modification to the initial event content; analyzing the modification to determine whether to apply the modification to the initial event content; and applying the modification to the initial event content.

14. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 13, wherein performing the engagement sampling comprises: monitoring a traditional activation of at least a portion of the plurality of event attendees; monitoring a question and answer session; monitoring an event acceptance rate; mining a specific event topic for relevance; monitoring a social interaction among at least a portion of the plurality of event attendees; or monitoring a multi-tasking interaction of at least a portion of the plurality of event attendees.
